Spring 2006, Volume VIII, Issue 2

The Mountainside

Coolfont Mountainside Association

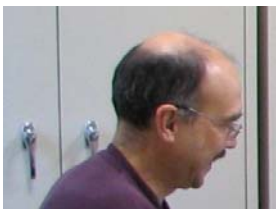
PO Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
www.coolfontmountainside.org...

From the President

By Jim Thompson

Spring has arrived at Coolfont, the blossoms are out and there's lots of activity on the mountainside.

Please note the date for the CMA Annual Meeting has changed to July 29th at Cacapon State Park since Treetop will be closed. We will be having the traditional Annual dinner in the Barn, a pool party on Sunday and hopefully some open houses. So please plan to join us!



Jim Thompson

The annual Pool Beautification Day will be May 20th and the Newcomers Brunch June 11th.

We will be making some changes to our Bylaws for member approval. This will permit us to shift the CMA fiscal year to the calendar year instead of July to June. This will make things easier for tax preparation, budget planning and Board transition after elections. We will propose a six month budget for remainder of 2006 and a 2007 budget at the Annual Meeting.

We continue to make improvements to our CMA infrastructure by completing maintenance on our "lagoon" and wetlands for sewage treatment, upgrading our North water reservoir and paving parts of Bobcat Drive. Finalizing grading, draining and planting of the old lagoon near the pool are in the plans, budget permitting.

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Nominations for the CMA Board Welcomed!

By Dilys Parry

Would you like to contribute to the betterment of the mountainside community? Do you have an interest in the future of CMA? Do you have skills you are willing to share? The Nominations Committee is now accepting nominations (including self nominations) for the CMA board.

What do board members do? Members attend a board meeting each month and take on oversight responsibilities for various committees and activities. Serving on the board can be a rewarding way to give back to the community, widen contacts with CMA members and help make

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CMA Calendar of Events

May 27th-29th
Berkeley Springs
Studio Art Tour
10 am-5 pm

June 10th
Board Meeting
CMA Office 10 am
Potluck 6:30 pm

~~June 11th~~
Newcomers Brunch
The Barn 11 am

~~July 29th~~
Board Meeting
CMA Office 10 am
Annual Meeting 1 pm
Cacapon State Park
Annual Dinner
The Barn 6:30 pm

July 30th
Pool Party 11 am

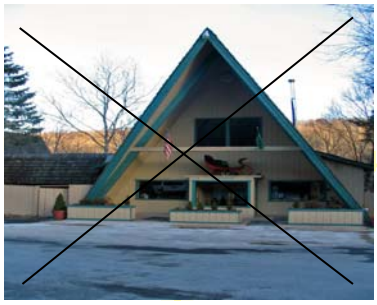
Coolfont Re+Creation

By Lois Copeland

The latest news from Coolfont Recreation. On May 31, 2006 CRI Management will transition all operations at Coolfont to its new owner. After May 31, Re+Creation, Inc. will be dissolved. Freeman will retain the Coolfont name.

As of June 1, 2006, all operations at Coolfont will be managed by Berkeley Springs Real Estate Services, LLC which is an entity established by Carl M. Freeman Associates, Inc. to oversee his West Virginia operations.

The agreements that were in place between CMA Homeowners and Coolfont Re+Creation, Inc. for rental of their homes have been terminated effective May 31. A new rental contract was mailed to all who have been participating in this collaboration. Any other CMA homeowner who wants to participate may contact the property manager at Berkeley Springs Real Estate Services at 304-258-4500.



Treetop will be demolished starting June 1, 2006

Security Services that has been provided to CMA through CRI will be terminated May 31. Berkeley Springs Real Estate Services is not in the position to continue this service. Other organizations are available to provide security.

This information was provided by George R. Haynes.

In and Around Berkeley Springs

By Lois Copeland

The Coolfont Foundation for the Arts will be dissolved following a Memorial Day Concert. **Peter Basquin**, noted pianist and frequent performer at Coolfont will play May 27 at 8:00 pm at the Presbyterian Church on 206 S Mercer St. Mr. Basquin, an old friend of CMA and always a delight to hear.

The Ashelman Family donated their piano to be housed at the Church for concerts by the Coalition of Artists for Morgan County.

Berkeley Springs State Park is now a wireless Hot Spot. A tourism grant from the West Virginia Cultural Heritage Development Program allows a signal to be available throughout the block of Fairfax Street.

On a sad note, Inspirations, our beloved restaurant closed this winter.



See Peter Basquin in concert, May 27th.

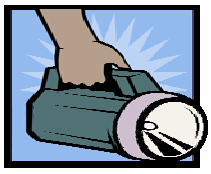
We will dearly miss the staff, the food, the music and the camaraderie.

Help for Homeowners

By Jean Cohen

If you only use your CMA home occasionally and wish that there was someone on the property to check it out for you, your wish may have been answered! Terry Miller has contacted us to let us know that he is interested in doing "monthly preventive maintenance" at your house. The items that he lists in his flier include:

- Checking smoke alarms
- Checking/replacing light bulbs
- Checking windows and storm doors
- Checking for leaks or water damage
- Checking heating and air conditioners



Need help?

- Other items may be negotiated between homeowner and Terry.

Terry advertises that he is interested in providing this maintenance for a fee of $106. Please call Terry directly for more information. 304-258-9289.

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

By Lois Copeland

The Berkeley Springs Annual Spring Studio Tour will be held on the Memorial Day Weekend. This self-guided event will feature 26 participating artists at 20 locations in and around Berkeley Springs. Among the participants are two of our own CMA neighbors, Rosemary Bigelow and Richard Kaufman, whose studios are located on the mountainside. Rosemary's work consists of an eclectic mix of home furnishings and accessories using textiles with a traditional feel, including custom bedding, pillows, window treatments, table linens and framed prints. Be sure to bring your fabric swatches and paint chips so you can select from Rosemary's large collection of fabrics.

Richard paints landscapes, seascapes and other views of nature. He works with specially prepared inks, colors and rice papers and combines traditional Asian and modern techniques.

There will be an opening reception in Berkeley Castle on Friday, May 26th, 6:30-9 pm where those attending can meet the artists and see examples of their work. The studios will be open Saturday through Monday, May 27, 28 and 29, 10 am-5 pm. More information about the tour can be found at:

www.BerkeleySpringsStudioTour.org

Berkeley Springs Studio Tour

Memorial Day Weekend

Opening reception Friday May 26th 6:30-9:00pm



From the President

(con't)

Bob Borchers is working on improvements to our CMA website.

Freeman Companies, new owners of Coolfont Resort, has issued new rental contracts for those who rent their home through Coolfont. We are still waiting for their plans for resort development.

The nominating committee, under the leadership of Dilys Parry, is seeking nominees to run for three Board positions this year. We also need two new members for the committee after the Annual Meeting. The membership will be asked at the Annual Meeting to extend the terms of the four board members who are not up for election until December 2007 and elect the three new Board Members through 2008 to align with the new Fiscal Year.



Hope to see you on the mountainside soon!

Nominations to the CMA Board

(con't)

decisions that will be crucial to our future.

The CMA Bylaws provide for a seven member Board, with either three or four members elected to a two-year term in alternate years. The Nominations Committee is now seeking suggestions for this year's slate of nominees to fill three Board vacancies. Names of potential candidates can be given to one of the members of the Committee: Dilys Parry (Chair); Martha Ashelman, Jackson Bain, Joan Claybrook and Lois Copeland.



"Serving on the Board can be a rewarding way to give back"

Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418
Berkeley Springs, WV 25411
Your Address Line 3

Phone: 301-530-1115
Phone: 304-258-8127
E-mail: locopeland@aol.com





Did the Droll Yankee Company say these feeders were squirrel proof?

Laura Braun, a CMA home owner, died Saturday, May 6 of leukemia. Diagnosed in the fall of 2004, she bravely fought this dreadful disease. Following a recuperation period she continued working at her wellness clinic, supported The Coolfont Foundation for the Arts and practiced a spiritual and natural way of life. We often saw her walking the mountainside loop after her illness was diagnosed.

In spite of her love for the mountainside, she, Chuck and their son Moshe moved to Pittsburgh the fall of 2005. She wanted Moshe to have a full religious life not possible on the mountainside.

She lived to see Moshe become a Bar Mitzvah March of this year. We send Chuck and Moshe our deepest sympathies.

Letter to the Editor

Road Paving

Is everyone comfortable with the casual destruction wreaked upon the mountainside? The paving of the living earth kills it! It can no longer absorb moisture. It still rains and snows. Where does the water go? It concentrates in the ditches with much greater force and volume. This increases the amount of erosion on our mountainside. More topsoil is loosened, more roots are exposed, greater amounts of mud and silt choke the rivulets, streams, rivers killing the micro and macroscopic life that is the food source of myriad insects, birds, mammals, etc.

Ignorance is no longer bliss; it is highly destructive. Do we really want to be a party in destroying our environment? Is there anyone out there who cares...who gives a damn? If so, please say something, do something, do something, please…

Sincerely,

Charles Balkan

*Letters appearing in this column are the opinion of the writer, not necessarily the **CMA Board.** We appreciate any response on this matter or any other matter concerning life on the mountainside, Coolfont Resort or the surrounding area.*



CMA Mountainside Road

Lois Copeland